

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

FRIDAY, JUNE 27, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Carrying heavy burdens

At Albizu High School, migrant grads confront a future shaped by US policy

By Nell Salzman | Chicago Tribune

After Juan Luna, 20, graduated from Dr. Pedro Albizu Campos Puerto Rican High School in early June, he stood in the lobby and cried. Juan came to Chicago alone from Mexico for his senior year, and the end of school meant the end of the community that had acted as his family.

He decided to move in with his godfather, who lives in the Humboldt Park neighborhood, to finish high school and pursue a college degree in architecture.

But since arriving in the United States, Juan has become disillusioned with the opportunities that are actually available to him. He's watched as President Donald Trump has threatened programs that could have helped him apply for scholarships.

"For someone from Mexico like me, the American Dream is fake," he said.

While many graduating seniors face doubts about jobs and the future, students like Juan carry additional burdens.

Many of the students at Albizu come from immigrant backgrounds, which can be challenging to navigate. Students who lack legal status to stay in the country wake up wondering if it will be their last day in the U.S., and those who do have legal status often carry guilt or worry that the government will take away their friends or friends' families.

The migrant students at Albizu High have competing priorities, similar to students experiencing homelessness, said the principal, Melissa Lewis. They often work to support their families back home or live with relatives or friends who aren't their

Turn to Graduates, Page 4

Above: Juan Luna fights back tears while Alma Moreno comforts him following his graduation ceremony from Dr. Pedro Albizu Campos Puerto Rican High School on June 3. Moreno is a staff member at the high school. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Pritzker officially seeking 3rd term

Castigates Trump, Dems who shy from progressive causes

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker formally declared his candidacy for a third term as Illinois' chief executive on Thursday, vowing to build on a legacy of accomplishments as he criticized President Donald Trump, called Republicans a "cult" and even slammed Democrats who are shying away from progressive social causes.

Kicking off his 2026 campaign in a 25-minute speech before a couple of hundred supporters at the Grand Crossing Fieldhouse on Chicago's South Side, Pritzker also did little to dispel speculation about a 2028 run for president. He routinely touched on national themes — including the importance of the youth vote and the need among Democrats to focus on affordability issues — and he dodged when asked if he would pledge to serve a full, four-year term if reelected governor in November 2026.

"I ran for governor in 2018 to change our story. I ran for governor in 2022 to keep telling our story. And I am running for governor in 2026 to protect our story because our story is now one of fiscal responsibility, of social accountability, of modern adaptability," Pritzker said. "Our story values love over hate, courage over fear, kindness over cruelty. Our story doesn't have a cult telling us what to believe, or sycophants telling us what to say, or a king telling us what to do."

Pritzker has emerged nationally as one of the most prominent Democratic voices taking on the Republican president among sometimes listless party leader-

Turn to Pritzker, Page 2

Hurdle emerges for Trump's tax cut and spending bill

GOP Medicaid plan violates Senate rules, chief arbiter advises

By Lisa Mascaro
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Senate parliamentarian has advised that a Medicaid provider tax overhaul central to President Donald Trump's tax cut and spending bill does not adhere to the chamber's procedural rules, delivering a crucial blow as Republicans rush to finish the package this week.

Guidance from the parliamentarian is rarely ignored and Republican leaders are now forced to

consider difficult options. Republicans were counting on big cuts to Medicaid and other programs to offset trillions of dollars in Trump tax breaks, their top priority. Additionally, the Senate's chief arbiter of its often complicated rules had advised against various GOP provisions barring certain immigrants from health care programs.

Republicans scrambled Thursday to respond, with some calling for challenging, or firing, the nonpartisan parliamentarian Elizabeth MacDonough, who has been on the job since 2012. Democrats said the decisions would devastate GOP plans.

Turn to Bill, Page 9



Firefighters, ATF and police investigate the scene of an extra-alarm fire early Thursday morning in the 5200 block of West North Avenue in Chicago. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

3 dead in Austin apartment fire

ATF investigating blaze as possible arson that also injured boy, 4

By Deanese Williams-Harris, Rebecca Johnson and Tess Kenny
Chicago Tribune

When Victor Delfi woke up about 2:15 a.m. to go to the bathroom, he heard gunshots outside in his Austin home. He didn't think much of it at first — there are frequent shootings in the neighborhood, he said.

But, about 10 seconds later, when he heard loud sirens from

firefighters and paramedics, he felt like something major was happening. When he looked out his window, he saw "a huge flame" erupting from the top of an apartment building in the 5200 block of West North Avenue.

"It's unbelievable," Delfi, 66, said. "Like something out of the demon world."

Three people — two adults and one child — died in the fire officials said. The victims include a 5-year-old boy, a 32-year-old woman and a 76-year-old man, according to Chicago police. Their identities had not been released as of Thursday evening.

Believed to be among the victims was a longtime community voice well known in the area, U.S. Rep. Danny Davis and his staff told the Tribune Thursday.

Authorities have yet to release the identification officially pending notification of the man's next of kin. The Tribune is withholding the man's name for that reason.

"There was no person who lived in the Austin community that was more important to the area than (him)," said Davis, whose district includes Austin.

A 4-year-old boy was also crit-

Turn to Fire, Page 9

INSIDE

Top brass defends Iran target claims

Pentagon leaders laid out new details Thursday to bolster their argument that U.S. attacks destroyed key Iranian nuclear facilities. **Nation & World**

Can 'Bear' live to cook another day?

In Season 4, staffers are holding out hope they can save the restaurant from closing. And one of the show's strengths is that you're rooting for them. **A+E**



JEFF ROBESON/AP

Imanaga silences Cardinals in return

Any lingering worries about Shota Imanaga's hamstring were answered as he allowed one hit in five shutout innings vs. St. Louis. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 87 Low 67

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 178 © Chicago Tribune

